

Agency

Automation

Find Your First 3 Highest-Value Automations

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A Personalized Audit Showing Exactly Which Make/Airtable/Shopify Workflows Will Save You 10+ Hrs/Week

The Trap Most Online SMBs Fall Into

You're running a Shopify store, selling on Takealot, maybe eBay. Orders come in. You're manually:

- Copying orders from Takealot -> Shopify -> Xero
- Updating inventory across 3 platforms
- Answering the same "Where's my order?" WhatsApp/email/Instagram DMs
- Building reports in Google Sheets at 11 PM on Sundays

You don't have an automation problem. You have a prioritization problem.

There are 50+ things you could automate. Only 3 will give you 80% of the time back.

The 3-Automation Framework We Use With Every Client

Step 1: Map Your "Time Tax" (15 min)

List every repetitive task. Score each:

- **Frequency:** How many times/day/week?
- **Duration:** Minutes per occurrence?
- **Error Cost:** What happens when it breaks? (Lost sale, angry customer, compliance issue)
- **Automatability:** Can a tool do this reliably? (1-5 scale)

Formula: Priority Score = Frequency × Duration × Error Cost × Automatability

Step 2: The Universal Top 3 for Online SMBs

After auditing 40+ SA e-commerce businesses, these 3 always rank highest:

#1: Unified Order -> Inventory -> Accounting Sync

Time Saved: 5-8 hrs/week

Tools: Make + Shopify + Takealot API + Xero/QuickBooks + Airtable (buffer)

The Flow:

New Order (Shopify/Takealot/eBay) -> Make router ->

- Create/Update order in Airtable (single source of truth)
- Decrement inventory in Airtable -> Push to ALL channels
- Create invoice in Xero -> Email customer
- └ Tag customer in Klaviyo/HubSpot for post-purchase flow

Why it wins: Eliminates overselling. Kills double-entry. Accounting stays current automatically.

Setup Complexity: Medium (Takealot API needs approval)

Maintenance: Near-zero once running

#2: Customer Comms Unification (WhatsApp + Email + Instagram -> One Inbox)

Time Saved: 3-5 hrs/week

Tools: Make + Gmail + WhatsApp Business API (Twilio) + Instagram Graph API + Airtable/Notion

The Flow:

Incoming message (any channel) -> Make webhook ->

- Log to Airtable "Comms" table (thread ID, channel, customer, timestamp)
- Check: Existing customer? -> Pull order history, attach to record
- Auto-reply: "Got it! [Name] responds within 2 hrs" (customized per channel)
- └ Notify team: Slack/Email/Telegram with context + quick-reply buttons

Why it wins: No more missed DMs. Context at fingertips. Response time drops from hours -> minutes.

Setup Complexity: Low-Medium

Maintenance: Add new channels in 10 min

#3: Automated Reporting You Actually Read

Time Saved: 2-3 hrs/week (but better decisions = more revenue)

Tools: Make + Airtable -> Google Slides / Notion / Email / WhatsApp

The Flow:

Daily 7 AM: Make pulls yesterday's data from Airtable (orders, revenue, conversion, ad spend, inventory alerts) ->

- Builds 1-page dashboard in Google Slides/Notion
- Emails PDF to you + key team

— WhatsApp voice note summary (via ElevenLabs TTS): "Yesterday: R47K revenue, 23 orders, 3.2% conv. Stock alert: SKU-402 at 12 units."

— Flags anomalies: "Conv dropped 40% vs 7-day avg -- check Meta ads"

Why it wins: You actually read it. Takes 60 seconds. Anomalies caught early.

Setup Complexity: Low

Maintenance: Zero

Your Personalized Audit: What You'll Get

Fill the form -> We analyze your stack + pain points -> Within 24 hrs you receive:

Deliverable	Format	What's Inside
Time Tax Audit	Notion page	Every repetitive task scored & ranked
Top 3 Automations	PDF + Loom video	Exact Make scenarios, effort estimates, ROI calc
"Start This Week" Pick	1-pager	The single highest-leverage build with step-by-step
Tool Gap Analysis	Spreadsheet	What you have, what you need, what to kill
30-min Strategy Call	Calendly link	Walk through the plan, Q&A, decide next steps

Real Example: "Sarah's Curated Homewares" (Cape Town)

Before: 14 hrs/week manual ops across Shopify, Takealot, Instagram, Xero

Top 3 Identified:

- Order->Inventory->Xero sync (saved 6.5 hrs)
- Instagram DM -> Airtable -> Slack (saved 3 hrs)
- Weekly dashboard to WhatsApp (saved 1.5 hrs + better decisions)

Result: 11 hrs/week reclaimed. First automation live in 3 days.

Revenue impact: +R340K in 90 days (faster fulfillment -> better reviews -> repeat rate ↑ 18%)

The Stack We Recommend (Free to Start)

Layer	Tool	Why
Automation	**Make**	Visual, powerful, 1,000 free ops
Database	**Airtable**	1,000 records free, great UI
WhatsApp	**Twilio** or **WhatsApp Business App**	API vs. manual tradeoff
Scheduling	**Calendly**	Free tier solid
Forms	**Tally.so**	Unlimited, beautiful, free
Reporting	**Google Slides/Notion**	Free, shareable
TTS (voice notes)	**ElevenLabs**	10k chars/mo free

At scale: ~R1,500-3,000/mo (Make Pro + Twilio + ElevenLabs)

Ready for Your Roadmap?

Book a free 30-minute AI Strategy Call and we'll:

- Run your Time Tax Audit live (15 min)
- Show the exact Make scenarios for your stack (10 min)
- Give you the deployment files -- or build turnkey (5 min)

No pitch. No pressure. Just your 3-automation roadmap.

-> Book Your Free Call Here

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